Building Trust and Engagement with Your Team

Module 1: Leading through change

Zachary Hunter



Same change. Two plants.



Chester

Model workforce



High Park

History of resisting change

By the end of this session, you'll be able to:

- Identify what's missing in a change message
- Write a sentence that fills the gap
- Start a template for a change you have coming up



Think of a change that landed badly.

How did you find out about it?

Fair process

People trust and cooperate when the process feels fair, even when the outcome isn't what they wanted.

Not consensus.
You still make the call.

Same decision, different process

Chester
Quality fell

High Park
Resistance never came

W. Chan Kim & Renee Mauborgne, INSEAD. Harvard Business Review, 1997.

Three principles of fair process



Engagement

Ask before it's final

Three principles of fair process



Engagement

Ask before it's final



Explanation

Share the why

Three principles of fair process



Engagement

Ask before it's final



Explanation

Share the why



Expectation clarity

What changes, and by when

Three principles of fair process



Engagement

Ask before it's final



Explanation

Share the why



Expectation clarity

What changes, and by when

Before your next decision or change, check all three.

What it sounds like

Example (fictional)

Next month we're moving our weekly meeting to Tuesdays, because Mondays have become our busiest day for walk-in traffic. Before I lock in the time, tell me by Friday which Tuesday slot works best. I'll send the final time and agenda by the 15th.

What it sounds like

Example (fictional)

Next month we're moving our weekly meeting to Tuesdays, **because Mondays have become our busiest day for walk-in traffic.** Before I lock in the time, tell me by Friday which Tuesday slot works best. I'll send the final time and agenda by the 15th.



Explanation
Share the why

What it sounds like

Example (fictional)

Next month we're moving our weekly meeting to Tuesdays, **because Mondays have become our busiest day for walk-in traffic.** **Before I lock in the time, tell me by Friday which Tuesday slot works best.** I'll send the final time and agenda by the 15th.



Explanation
Share the why



Engagement
Ask before it's final

What it sounds like

Example (fictional)

Next month we're moving our weekly meeting to Tuesdays, **because Mondays have become our busiest day for walk-in traffic.** **Before I lock in the time, tell me by Friday which Tuesday slot works best.** **I'll send the final time and agenda by the 15th.**



Explanation
Share the why



Engagement
Ask before it's final



Expectation clarity
What changes, and by when

Which one is missing?

Example (fictional)

"Team: starting November 1, front desk coverage moves to a rotating schedule, because two staff members are retiring and we need cross-coverage. Your shifts are on the shared calendar, and swap requests come to me."

1. **Engagement**
2. **Explanation**
3. **Expectation clarity**

Which one is missing?



1 Engagement



2 Explanation

"because two staff members are retiring"



3 Expectation clarity

Which one is missing?



1 Engagement



2 Explanation

"because two staff members are retiring"



3 Expectation clarity

"November 1… shared calendar… swaps come to me"

It's 1: Engagement

1 Engagement	Missing	_____
2 Explanation	*"because two staff members are retiring"*	
3 Expectation clarity	*"November 1… shared calendar… swaps come to me"*	

Write the sentence you'd add.

Your turn: a template for a real change





Coming up: _____



I'll ask the team: _____



I'll explain why: _____



What changes, and by when: _____

Keep it going



Job aid: keep it handy

Use the front checklist before your next decision or change.



Follow-up: 30-day check-in

Proposed for a full rollout: a short knowledge check, and a chance to report back on how you used your template.

One module of a fuller program

Module 1 (today)

Leading through change

›

Possible

Ongoing feedback vs. over-monitoring

›

Possible

Recognition, development and strengths

›

Possible

Psychological safety and responding to mistakes

Later modules are possibilities, not existing courses.



Questions

References

Gallup. (n.d.). What is employee engagement and how do you improve it? https://www.gallup.com/workplace/285674/improve-employee-engagement-workplace.aspx

Kim, W. C., & Mauborgne, R. (2003, January). Fair process: Managing in the knowledge economy. Harvard Business Review (reprint of the 1997 article).

Virginia Department of Human Resource Management. (2025). Policy 1.40, Performance planning and evaluation (revised August 22, 2025). https://www.dhrm.virginia.gov/docs/default-source/hrpolicy/policy-1-40-performance-management.pdf